Coking Coal

Rank	Country	Production MT	Share in%
1	China	591,998,000	54.67
2	Australia	189,302,000	17.48
3	Russia	83,800,000	7.74
4	India	61,661,000	5.69
5	United States	50,645,000	4.68
	Others		9.74

Major coal mining centres

Country	Mining centres
China	Shansi, Shantung, Fushun, Shenyang, etc.
India	Bokaro, Jaria, Korba, Ranikanch, Singreni, etc.
U.S.A	Arkansas, Colorodo, Illionois, Indiana, Michigan etc.
Australia	Bowen Basin, Brisbane, Canberra, Sydney, New-castle, Tasmania, etc.
Russia	Moscow-Tula region, Chokot Basin, Ob basin, etc.

Trade

The main exporters of coal in the world are Australia, Indonesia, Russia, Colombia and South Africa and the main importers are China, India, Japan, Korea and Germany.

Uses of Coal

Man has used coal for hundreds of years. But it has gained importance only after industrial revolution. It contributes about 25% of global energy demand. Coal is used for various purposes. It is used as a source of steam energy, electrical energy, domestic fuel, metallurgical coke, chemical industries and byproducts such as Ammonium sulphate, Naphthalene, Phenol, Benzene, etc.

Petroleum (or) Mineral oil

Petroleum is a mineral that exists under the surface of the earth in liquid, solid and gaseous forms. Liquid petroleum may be in the form of crude oil. The solid form may be mineral waxes or asphalts. The gaseous form is natural gas. It is a main source of energy in the World due to its multiple uses. The human activities are directly or indirectly depend on the use of petroleum or its sub products.

Formation and occurrence of mineral oil

It is formed by residual chemical and bio chemical decomposition of the remains of organic matter in sedimentary rocks. It is found in the pores of the sedimentary rocks. Oil is lighter than water hence, floats over water. Drilling of oil wells is the hole drilled in the earth's crust and when it reaches the rock cap, the natural gas comes out first with a great pressure. When the pressure of gas subsides, petroleum starts flowing out when the pressure of natural gas is released.

Petroleum reserves of the world

The west Asia or Middle East is has the largest petroleum reserves, which is about 60% of the world's oil reserve. The total estimated world's oil reserves in 2008 were 1,243 (10^9 bbl). Saudi Arabia, Canada, Iran, Iraq and Kuwait have large reserves of petroleum.

Production and world distribution of petroleum

The petroleum producing countries of the world can be grouped in to five geographical regions:

(i) West Asia (or) middle East region
(ii) American region
(iii) Russian region
(iv) East & south Asian region and
(v) African region

Saudi Arabia is the largest oil producer of the world with 13.62% of the world output of oil. Russia is the second largest producer in the world. India is placed at 24th position in petroleum production in the world. The distribution of oil is naturally uneven; Middle

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